



Controlling access via configuration files is not only good, but necessary too!

.htaccess, Microsoft IIS servers have `useweb.config` and Nginx servers use `nginx.conf` as their respective server configuration files.

Some essential rules that you should enforce on your web server through the configuration files are as follows. Prevent directory browsing – prevents malicious users from browsing and cataloguing every directory on the website or server; Protecting sensitive files – especially the CMS configuration file, since it's one of the most sensitive files on the web server, holding the database login details in plain text.

Install a web application firewall (WAF)

Just like you are keen to protect all your digital endpoints – PC, laptop, smartphone, etc. – with a security software (antivirus) of some kind, similarly you need to secure your website, too. Enter WAF or a web application firewall, which is a server plugin or a separate software appliance that sits between your web server and incoming / outgoing communication lines, monitoring the traffic that wants to establish a connection to your website.

Essentially what a WAF does is that it defines a strict set of rules when it comes to allowing who gets to connect to your website and who doesn't. It's typically sensitive to sifting through HTTP traffic and keeping an eye out for XSS (cross-site scripting) and SQL injection attacks – some of the most common hack attack vectors – but it can be configured to stay alert and vigilant about more sophisticated attacks as well. Most modern WAF solutions are capable of dealing with DDoS and other advanced potential web threats, too.

WAF can be deployed both at a hardware and a software level. Unlike very few popular and reliable PC security vendors, the market for WAF is inundated with a whole bevy of products offering different levels of